back to Peshawar, we could not have gone back to Sindh. In the course of history, every country has ups and downs. But it does not mean that our country will remain partitioned for all time.' Notice the 'we' in this construction—the country, in his perception, was Hindu.

The place of the Muslim too is clarified. 'The Muslims of this country are not foreigners,' said Madhok. 'About ninety eight percent of them are Hindu converts. Their forefathers were the same as mine. Their culture is the same as mine. Culture has little to do with religion. The whole of Europe is Christian. But Germany has its own German culture. France has its own French culture and Italy has Italian culture. Similarly, whatever the religions of India may be, India has one culture and that is the Indian culture we stand for. That culture has its roots in the Vedas. In the course of our long history so many currents from left and right, from outside and inside, have come and joined it. But just as the streams, which join Ganga become Ganga; its water remains "Ganga-jal", we do not call its water "Ganga-Jamuna Jal" or "Ganga-Gandak Jal", similarly other currents that have come into India's cultural stream have become indistinguishable part of our culture.'[121]

Herein lay the rub. If everything was indistinguishable, then what was the place of each community in a society with clear religious differences. If it was the Hindu past that was to be reclaimed, then what was the status of the rest? What about the composite culture, the Ganga–Jamuna Tehzeeb, that was built up by secular nationalists over the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries? To this, Madhok had a clear answer. The 'talk of composite culture is wrong, is unrealistic and is dangerous. Indian culture is one.'[122] The Sangh did not think this was a communal answer. The 'charge about communalism against Jana Sangh is just like spitting on the moon,' Madhok declared. 'Anyone who spits on the moon, simply spits on his own face.'[123]

In 2020, Modi spoke of 130 crore deshwasis (country residents) and of 'Sab Ka Saath Sab Ka Vikaas', but we can find early versions of this talk from the 1960s. As Madhok put it, 'When we talk about people of this country we mean 50 crore people and not that one percent of people who hold all the power in this country. Therefore, we judge the progress of this country by the progress that the